

Public Services Committee of the Muncie City Council - June 26, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DUO5Cym4r84
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: No statutory public hearing or separate committee session was held prior to the start of the recorded proceedings.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The transcript captures a working session or committee meeting of the Muncie City Council discussing fire station projects, budget figures, and related capital improvements.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Council members explicitly referenced or speaking during the session include Mr. Burfer, Miss Golly, Jeff, and another unnamed council member presiding over/guiding portions of the discussion.
 - **Staff / Presenters:** The Fire Chief and Greg (representing GM Development / project management) were present to answer technical and construction questions.
 - **Absent:** The meeting administration and bond attorney were noted as absent (the bond attorney was on vacation).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not mentioned in the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not mentioned in the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:01 Discussion of Temporary Fire Station / Jackson Building Lease & Renovations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Chief and Greg (GM Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members questioned the financial arrangement regarding the Jackson building, which will serve as a temporary location during Station 5's rebuild. The city is entering a 2-year, \$1-dollar lease and investing approximately \$400,000 into building renovations (accommodating 24-hour shifts) and erecting a steel building for fire trucks. Upon vacating, the property owner retains the improved building. The Chief noted that extensive searching yielded few viable alternatives to maintain response times in that sector. It was also noted that Ball State University committed \$1.5 million to the fire station project and increased its annual fire protection service fee to \$300,000, though negotiations with Ball Hospital were not pursued.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded during this segment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote recorded.
- **00:02:22 Financial Review of Station 6 Bond Savings & Contingency Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Greg (GM Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Officials reviewed remaining bond funds after issuance costs (\$8,425,900) compared against the final cost of Station 6 (\$7,948,063.22), leaving an under-budget savings of \$477,836.78. Project representatives clarified that these remaining funds do not revert to the general fund; legally, they must be applied either toward the fire department's capital needs or to pay down debt. The Fire Department intends to utilize available contingency funds toward future renovations at Station 7.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.
- **00:05:07 Design and Specifications for Station 5 Rebuild**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Chief and Greg (GM Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members inquired about the square footage and bunk capacity of the new station compared to Station 6. The Chief reported that the new station features two floors (7,875 sq. ft. per floor) plus a 1,562 sq. ft. mezzanine, totaling 17,312 sq. ft. (larger than Station 6), with four longer apparatus bays and 10 individual bunks. The design accounts for future staffing expansion,

paramedic student internships, spare ambulances for Ball State special events, and an EMS restocking point near Ball Hospital. The building will incorporate both stairways and a traditional fire pole.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.
- **00:13:54 Utilization of Union Labor and High School Apprenticeships**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Greg (GM Development) and Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members emphasized the importance of utilizing local and union labor for the upcoming station projects. Greg confirmed that union contractors (such as Hagerman) would be utilized. He highlighted a milestone achievement from the Station 6 project: overcoming insurance hurdles to establish the state's first high school union-wage paid internship on a public construction project.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote recorded.
- **00:16:00 Comparative Construction Costs and Multi-Story Architecture**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Greg (GM Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council and developer discussed comparative fire station costs across Indiana. Greg explained that post-2020 construction inflation requires a complete reset of historical cost comparisons. He noted that while single-story stations are more economical per square foot, multi-story urban or transitional stations (such as those previously built in Whitestown) require specialized architectural integration to fit residential-institutional transitional zones near universities and hospitals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote recorded.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public forum or citizen comment period was conducted during this session, as presiding members noted that public comment is reserved for regular Tuesday council meetings.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Council members praised the completed Station 6 project, noting its positive visual and safety impact on the Whitley and Morningside neighborhoods, as well as the custom table crafted from a tree cleared at the site. Due to the absence of the bond attorney and administrative representatives required to answer

remaining financial questions, further technical inquiries were deferred to the upcoming full council meeting.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was informally adjourned following a motion by the chair at [00:20:57](#).

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